

Ruofan Ma

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Harvard University, USA

Ph.D., Government2026 (*exp.*)
Fields of interest: IR (major), CP (minor), Labor Politics (focus)
Dissertation: *Global Governance and Labor Rights*
Committee: Christina Davis (Chair), Stephen Chaudoin, Kosuke Imai
A.M., Statistics2026 (*exp.*)
A.M., East Asian Studies2020

University of Oxford, UK

Visiting Ph.D. Student, DPIR2024-2025
Visiting Junior Scholar, Nuffield College

Peking University, China

B.A., Politics and Public Administration (with Honors)2018
Minors: Economics, Philology
Magna cum laude

WORKING PAPERS

1. “**International Monitoring and Labor Rights: Third Party Participation Deepens Compliance**”, (Job Market Paper, *under review at International Organization*)
 - Recipient of the 2024 ISA IO Section Lawrence Finkelstein Prize for the Best Graduate Student Paper
 - Recipient of the 2024 ISA IPE Section Best Graduate Student Paper Award
2. “**BIT by BIT: Network Learning and Investment Treaty Proliferation**” (with Licheng Liu, *under review at World Politics*)
3. “**Domestic Judicialization: Tariffs, Courts, and the Future of International Trade**” (with Mengyi Wang, *under review at Perspective on Politics*)
4. “**Assumption Smuggling in Intermediate Outcome Tests of Causal Mechanisms**” (with Matthew Blackwell and Aleksei Opacic, *under review at Journal of Politics*)
5. “**Sanction Spillovers and Trade Diversification**” (with Christina L. Davis, *under review at American Political Science Review*)
6. “**Uncertain Signals: Partisan Cues and Voters’ Support for Trade Agreements**” (with Ethan Miles, *prepared for submission*)
7. “**Adapation Across International Organizations: Evidence from the ILO and UPR**” (with Averell Schmidt)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. “Dynamic Bipartite Stochastic Blockmodel Regression for Network Data: Application to State and Intergovernmental Organization Networks” (with Qi Liu, Santiago Olivella, and Kosuke Imai)
2. “Multilateral Standards, Bilateral Labor Agreements”

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS	- American Political Science Association Annual Conference, 2023, 2024, 2025 – APSA Comparative Labor Conference, 2024, 2025 - International Studies Association Annual Conference, 2024, 2025 - Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, 2023 - International Political Economy Society, 2024 - Political Economy of International Organization, 2024 - Society for Political Methodology Annual Conference (PolMeth), 2024, 2025 - Political Networks and Computational Social Science Annual Conference (Pol-Net), 2025
GRANTS AND AWARDS	Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard University 2025 -2026 Traveling Scholar Fellowship, Institute of Humane Studies 2025 Summer Research Fund, Asia Center 2023 Research Grant, IQSS 2021, 2022, 2023 Raymond Vernon Fellowship, Harvard University 2020 - 2022 Summer Language Fund, Weatherhead Center 2020, 2021 Summer Research Fund, Fairbank Center 2019 National Scholarship, Peking University 2016, 2017, 2018
TEACHING	Harvard University Gov2018: Machine Learning Spring 2024 Teaching Fellow with Prof. Naijia Liu and Connor Jerzak Gov2002: Quantitative Social Science Methods II Spring 2023 Teaching Fellow with Prof. Matthew Blackwell Gov1740: International Law and Institutions Fall 2022, Fall 2023 Teaching Fellow with Prof. Christoph Mikulaschek
SERVICE	Co-organizer, APSA Comparative Labor Conference 2025 2024 - 2025 International Relations Workshop Coordinator, Harvard University 2022 - 2024 Communication Officer, Harvard Government GSA 2021 - 2022 Diversity Committee Member, Harvard GSC 2021 - 2022
RESEARCH ASSISTANT	Professor Inken von Borzyskowski, University of Oxford 2025 Professor Christoph Mikulaschek, Harvard University 2023 - 2024 Professor Christina Davis, Harvard University 2020 - 2024 Professor Jian Zhang, Peking University 2018 Professor Ling Li, Peking University 2017 - 2018 Professor Yuhua Wang, Harvard University 2016
SKILLS	Technical: R, Stata, Python, L ^A T _E X, ArcGIS Language: Mandarin (Native), English (C2), German (B1), Latin (Advanced)
REFERENCES	- Christina Davis (Committee Chair): cldavis@harvard.edu Edwin O. Reischauer Professor of Japanese Politics, Department of Government, Harvard University. - Kosuke Imai: imai@g.harvard.edu Professor, Department of Government and Department of Statistics, Harvard University. - Stephen Chaudoin: chaudoin@fas.harvard.edu Assistant Professor, Department of Government, Harvard University.

- Matthew Blackwell: mblackwell@gov.harvard.edu
Data Scientist, Google.

Updated May 2026